Google Cloud AI Builder Cup 2026

No Fine Print

Which competitions can your team actually win?

It reads the rules of hackathons, grants and innovation challenges, checks every member of your team against them, quotes the clause behind every verdict, and ranks what is left by prize money per entrant.

Problem statement

Future of Work & Enterprise Productivity

Age Limit: Every participant must be at least 21 years of age at the time of registration.

Professional Status Only: Participation is strictly restricted to working professionals, entrepreneurs, and startups.

Strict Student Prohibition: Full-time or part-time students are strictly ineligible. If any single member of a team is found to be a student, the entire team will be immediately disqualified, even if discovered after shortlisting, selection, or completion of the Grand Finale.

Geographic & Residency Restriction: All participants must be physically based in and legal residents of countries within the JAPAC (Japan & Asia-Pacific) region. [...]

From this competition's terms and conditions: the kind of clause No Fine Print reads, checks against every teammate, and quotes back.

Team No Fine Print Live app: no-fine-print-233540464251.asia-southeast1.run.app Code: github.com/chizheyu/no-fine-print

Every number in this deck names its source at the foot of its slide. **Excerpt:** AI Builder Cup terms and conditions, as saved on 11 Oct 2026 in the repository (`eval/snapshots`).

The clause that disqualifies a team is the one nobody reads

Small teams pick competitions with almost no decision support. Three traps, all from this competition's own terms:

One teammate studies part-time

"Full-time or part-time students are strictly ineligible. If any single member of a team is found to be a student, the entire team will be immediately disqualified, even if discovered after shortlisting, selection, or completion of the Grand Finale."

The prototype was started before the build window

"Pre-existing products, ongoing projects, or code developed prior to the official launch will be disqualified."

The terms never give the date of that launch. What counts is the first commit, not the day the repository went public.

One teammate works for the sponsor

The terms name no company whose staff are excluded, yet sponsors usually bar their own staff. Silence is not permission.

98 of 113

open competitions in our seed dataset had at least one condition (residency, student status, or whether existing work counts) that our first research pass could not pin down from the official pages.

S$0.55 to S$2,322

expected prize per registrant, across the 25 events where both the prize pool and the registrant count are public. A big pool can be worth little per entrant.

Sources: clauses from the AI Builder Cup terms and conditions, saved 11 Oct 2026 (`eval/snapshots`), labels in `eval/gold.json`. Figures from the README: seed dataset of 175 events checked against official pages, 28 Sep to 6 Oct 2026.

From one GitHub link to a shortlist you can defend

1. **Dossier from a GitHub link**
   Quoted README facts and the first-commit date
2. **Eligibility, member by member**
   Every verdict quotes the clause it rests on
3. **Ranking by expected prize per entrant**
   Prize pool divided by registrants, not pool size
4. **Due diligence with sources**
   Gemini searches; every sentence cites a page
5. **An application kit that cannot overclaim**
   Facts cite the dossier; a guard checks numbers
6. **Blind judge simulation**
   Sees only the kit and the official criteria
7. **Prediction ledger**
   Odds logged before you commit, scored after results

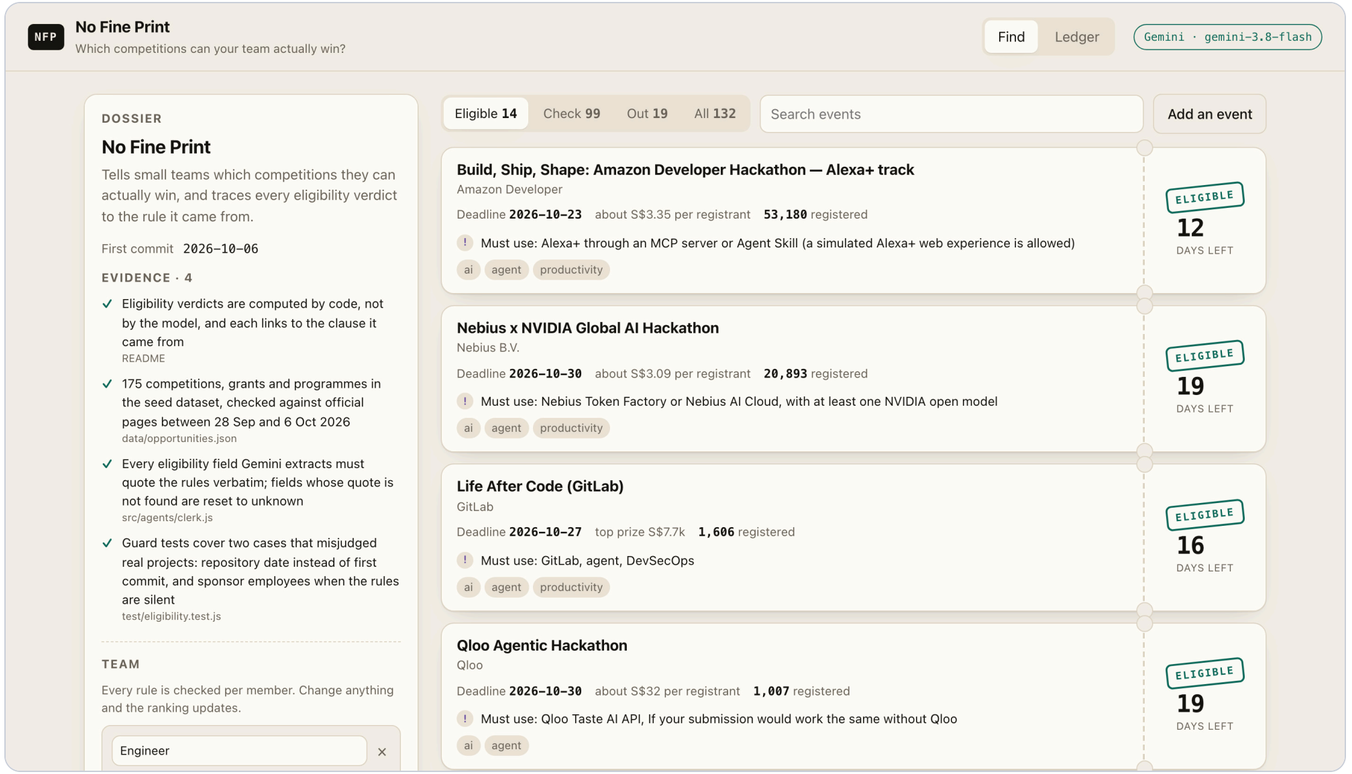


Exhibit A. The live app ranking 132 events for a fictional three-person sample team: 14 eligible, 99 to check, 19 out.

Source: live app, captured 11 Oct 2026 with Playwright at 1440 by 900. The sample team ships with the app and is fictional.

Every verdict names the member, the rule and the clause

The sample team (fictional)

Engineer	Singapore citizen, employed
Designer	Based in Asia-Pacific, employed
Data scientist	Singapore PR, employed, **studies part-time**

> For the AI Builder Cup the engine returns **Out**: one part-time student disqualifies the whole team. The clause is quoted, with a link to read it in context.

ELIGIBLE **Passes every rule** we could check against the team

CHECK **The rules or the dossier leave it open:** verify before you build

OUT **A rule disqualifies the team**

No model takes part here: `src/engine/eligibility.js` is plain code with tests. Ranking then uses expected prize per entrant: **S$38,700 ÷ 20,621 registrants, about S$1.88 each.**



Exhibit B. The AI Builder Cup, checked member by member for the sample team (top of the event panel).

Sources: live app, 11 Oct 2026 (pool, registrants counted 5 Oct 2026, and the per-registrant figure are as the app shows them); `src/engine/eligibility.js`.

Every number in a draft must come from the dossier

The Coach drafts (Gemini)

A pitch, a map to the judging criteria, submission text, a 3-minute demo script, a checklist and the compliance risks. A sentence that relies on a fact ends with its evidence id, like **[E3]**. A missing fact becomes **[TODO]**, never a made-up number.

The guard checks (code)

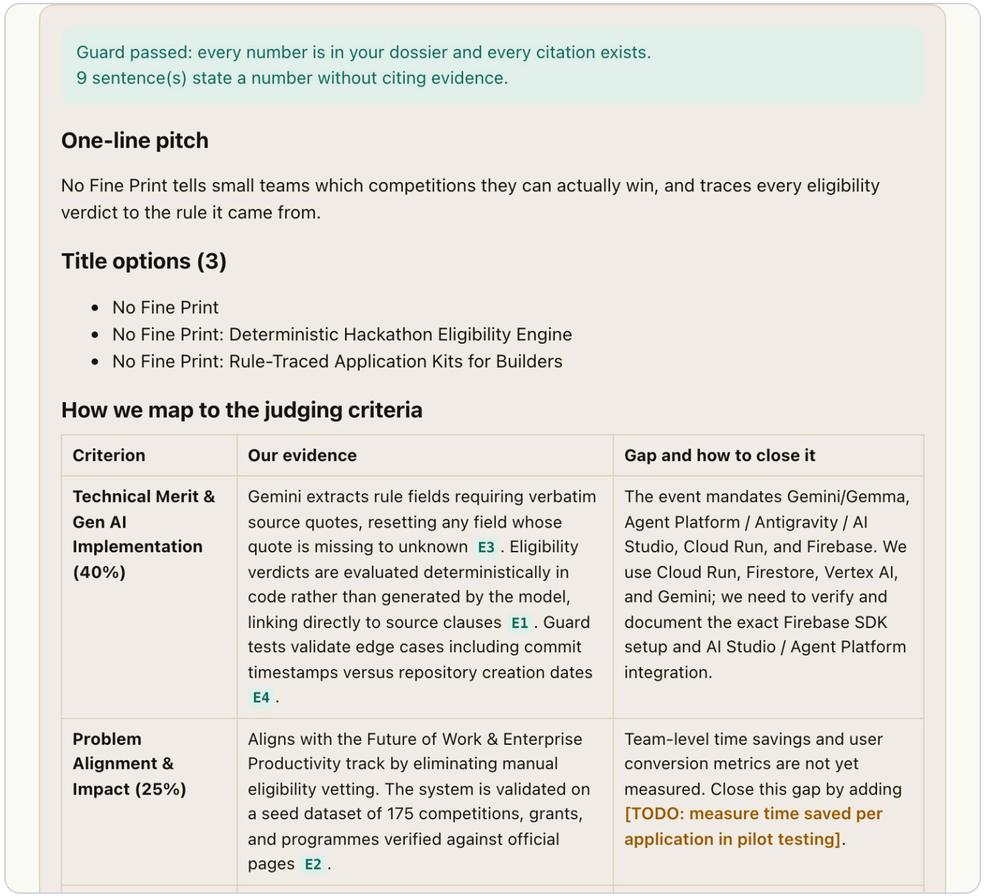
It flags any number the dossier does not contain, matching whole numbers and units: a “40%” judging weight does not back “saved 40 hours”. It also flags citations to evidence that does not exist, and promises such as “guaranteed to win”.

Blind judges (Gemini)

A separate call sees only the kit and the official criteria with their weights. It scores each criterion and names the three changes that would raise the score most.

Prediction ledger

Log your chance of a prize and the hours you will spend before you commit. Once results are in, the ledger scores your calibration with the Brier score: 0 is perfect, 0.25 is a coin flip. Drafts stay drafts: teams rewrite and submit their own work.



Guard passed: every number is in your dossier and every citation exists.
9 sentence(s) state a number without citing evidence.

One-line pitch

No Fine Print tells small teams which competitions they can actually win, and traces every eligibility verdict to the rule it came from.

Title options (3)

- No Fine Print
- No Fine Print: Deterministic Hackathon Eligibility Engine
- No Fine Print: Rule-Traced Application Kits for Builders

How we map to the judging criteria

Criterion	Our evidence	Gap and how to close it
Technical Merit & Gen AI Implementation (40%)	Gemini extracts rule fields requiring verbatim source quotes, resetting any field whose quote is missing to unknown `E3`. Eligibility verdicts are evaluated deterministically in code rather than generated by the model, linking directly to source clauses `E1`. Guard tests validate edge cases including commit timestamps versus repository creation dates `E4`.	The event mandates Gemini/Gemma, Agent Platform / Antigravity / AI Studio, Cloud Run, and Firebase. We use Cloud Run, Firestore, Vertex AI, and Gemini; we need to verify and document the exact Firebase SDK setup and AI Studio / Agent Platform integration.
Problem Alignment & Impact (25%)	Aligns with the Future of Work & Enterprise Productivity track by eliminating manual eligibility vetting. The system is validated on a seed dataset of 175 competitions, grants, and programmes verified against official pages `E2`.	Team-level time savings and user conversion metrics are not yet measured. Close this gap by adding **[TODO: measure time saved per application in pilot testing]**.

Exhibit C. The top of a kit for the AI Builder Cup, drafted from the sample dossier. Evidence ids link each claim to the dossier; gaps are left as [TODO], not invented.

Sources: live app, 11 Oct 2026; `src/agents/coach.js`, `src/engine/guards.js`, `web/app.js` (Brier score); README.

Gemini reads; code decides

The model may propose anything; only code that anyone can read and test acts on it. Four rules hold everywhere:

Every claim about the rules quotes the rules

Gemini	fills each eligibility field and copies the sentence that states it
Code	finds that sentence in the page we fetched, tolerating typography and list bullets, nothing else
If not found	the field resets to “unknown” and is shown to you as something to read

Verdicts come from a rule engine, not a model

Gemini	not used
Code	checks each member’s location, residency, student and employment status, age and employer against each rule, and returns the clause it relied on
Tested	on cases that misjudged real projects: repository date instead of first commit; sponsor staff when the rules are silent

Drafts cannot overclaim

Gemini	drafts the application kit, citing the dossier as [E3]
Code	flags numbers the dossier lacks, citations that do not exist, and promised outcomes
If flagged	the number is highlighted before anyone copies the draft

Web findings must cite a page

Gemini	searches with Google Search grounding and reads the event’s pages with URL context
Code	lays the API’s grounding supports over every sentence: all of its digits and at least 95% of its letters must be covered
If not	it goes to a collapsed “without a source” list. A contradiction needs each side backed on its own

Sources: README (How it decides); `src/quotes.js`, `src/agents/clerk.js`, `src/engine/eligibility.js`, `src/engine/guards.js`, `src/agents/investigator.js`.

A real catch: this event’s themes page contradicts itself

We pressed **Investigate** on the Google Cloud AI Builder Cup. Gemini read **3 of 3** official pages and ran **7** Google searches. All **4** sentences it wrote are tied to a cited page by Google’s grounding, so all 4 are shown.

A The page lists six themes: BFSI; Retail & Commerce; Manufacturing; Media, Content & Digital Experiences; Future of Work & Enterprise Productivity; Sustainability & Social Impact.

B “Category Specification: Clearly identify the problem statement you are submitting for (Healthcare, Education, Sustainability, Accessibility, Social Good).”

Both sides cite **aibuildercup.com/themes.html**, the event’s own page, and the card says so. That is why this submission names its problem statement in full: **Future of Work & Enterprise Productivity.**

The rules engine never acts on a card. It is evidence for you to read, shown with Google’s Search Suggestions as grounding requires.

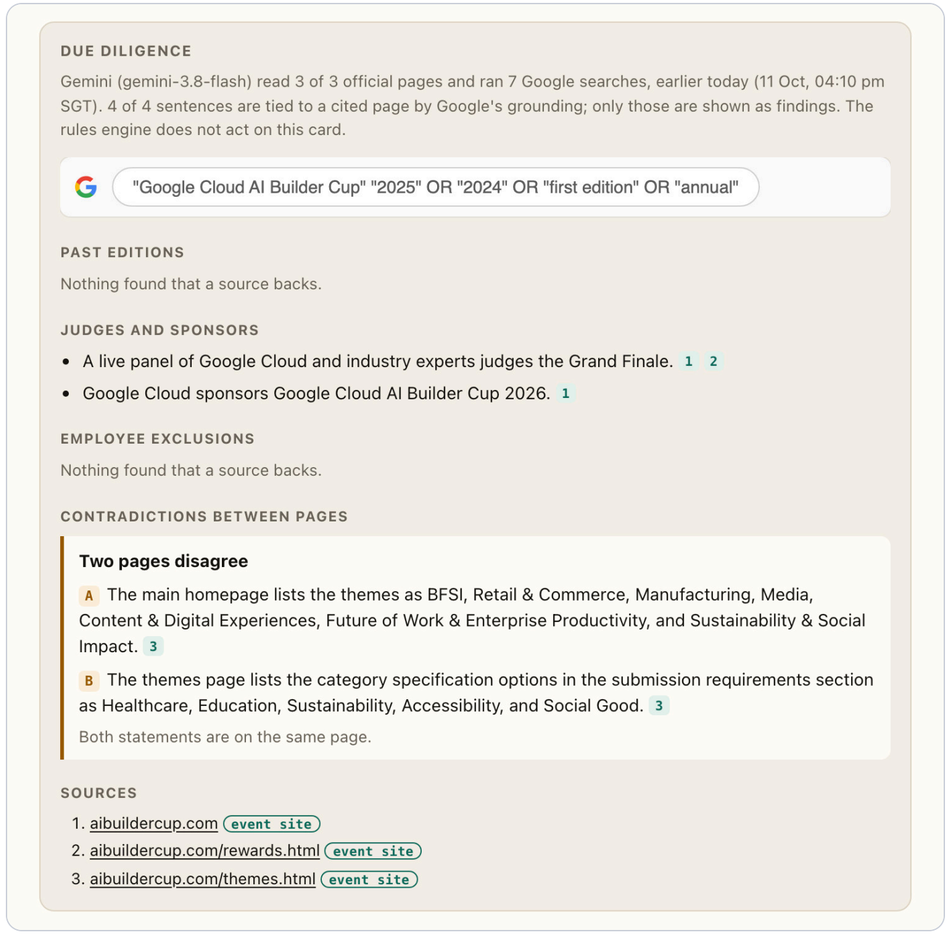
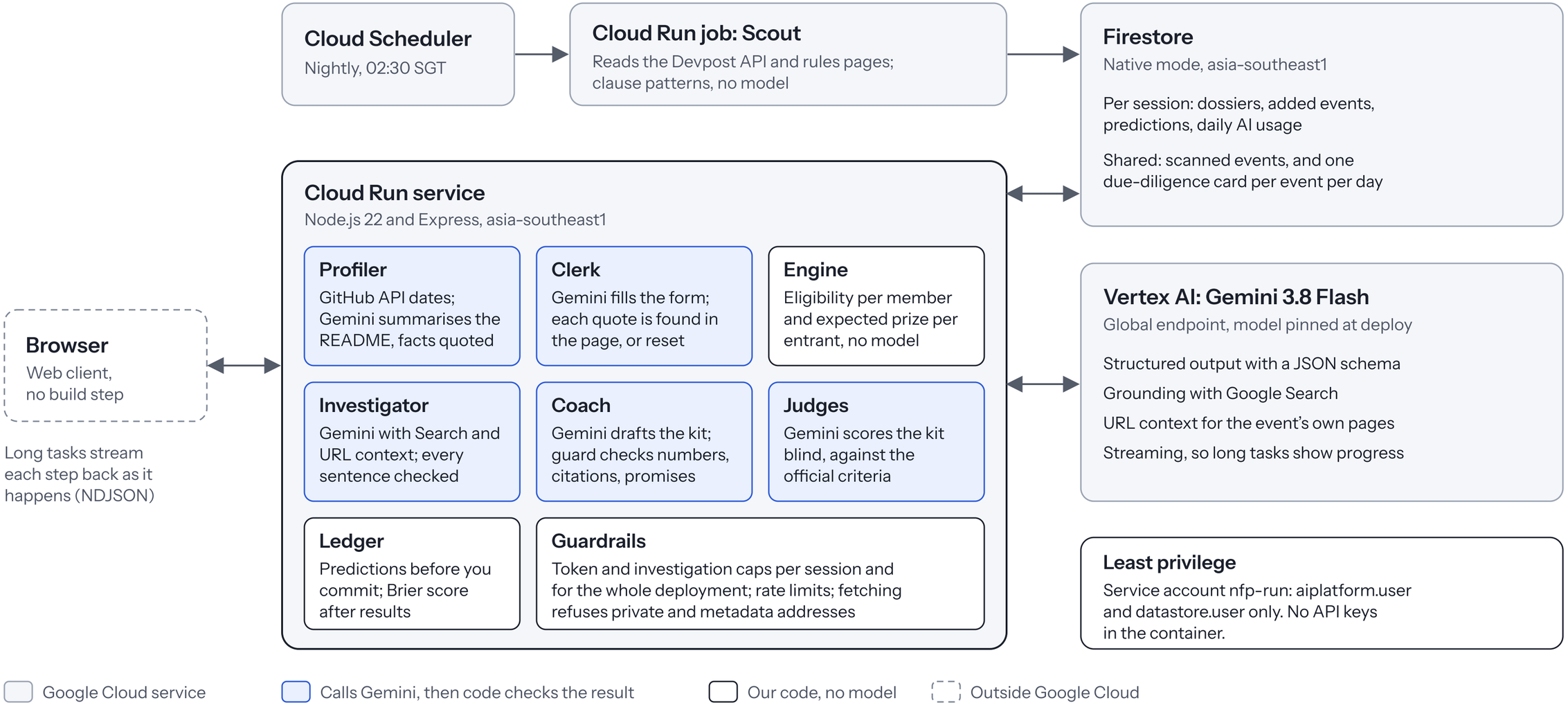


Exhibit D. The card as the live app shows it, made 11 Oct 2026 at 16:10 SGT. Its “Two pages disagree” heading is the fallback this card was made with; it now reads “These statements disagree”.

Sources: live app, due-diligence card of 11 Oct 2026; side B quoted from aibuildercup.com/themes.html, read 11 Oct 2026; README (Due diligence, with sources).

Serverless on Google Cloud, with Gemini on Vertex AI



Sources: README (Architecture; Deploy to Google Cloud); live `/api/status` on 11 Oct 2026: Vertex AI, gemini-3.8-flash, Firestore.

Each Gemini call has one job, and code checks its work

Agent	What Gemini does	How it is called	What code checks before you see it
Profiler	Summarises the README into a dossier	Structured output (JSON schema), temperature 0	Each fact must quote the README; dates, licence and stars come from the GitHub API
Clerk	Fills the eligibility form from the rules	Structured output, temperature 0, up to 150,000 characters of rules	Each quote must be found in the fetched page, or the field resets to “unknown”
Investigator	Past editions, judges, sponsors, staff exclusions, contradictions	Google Search grounding, URL context on up to 3 official pages, low thinking, at most 6 searches requested	Grounding supports laid over each sentence: all digits and 95% of letters, or it is set apart
Coach	Drafts the application kit	Streamed at temperature 0.4, with live progress	Numbers not in the dossier, citations to missing evidence, promised outcomes
Judges	Score the kit blind	Structured output, temperature 0.2; given only the kit and the official criteria	Advice only: the team rewrites and submits its own work

Spending is capped per day

400,000 tokens per session and 3,000,000 for the deployment; 30 model calls per session per 10 minutes; 8 investigations per session and 40 in all, because grounding is billed per search query.

One card per event per day

A due-diligence card holds only public facts, so every visitor shares it: a second click costs nothing. The rules engine is never rate-limited.

Untrusted input stays data

Prompts mark fetched rules, READMEs and submissions as data, never instructions. Fetching refuses private and metadata addresses, after redirects and DNS too.

Sources: `src/agents/` (clerk, profiler, investigator, coach, llm), `src/app.js`, `src/sources/fetchPage.js`; README (Deploy to Google Cloud: spending caps).

We test extraction on 45 hand-labelled fields, traps included

Five events: the AI Builder Cup terms, PayPal AI Hackathon, Build With AI: Basics, Qloo Agentic Hackathon and Meta VR START. Each label was checked against a saved snapshot of the official page, the exact text the model reads, and carries the sentence that justifies it. Nine labels are traps; for five of them “unknown” is the only right answer.

Run	Model (Vertex AI endpoint)	Events	Fields correct	Quotes verified	Confident errors	Traps passed
2026-10-08	gemini-3.8-flash (global)	2	17 / 17	14 / 14	0	1 / 1
2026-10-11	gemini-2.5-flash (asia-southeast1)	5	28 / 45	22 / 28	2	5 / 9
2026-10-11	gemini-3.8-flash (global, production)	5	42 / 45	31 / 35	0	9 / 9
2026-10-11, after fixes	gemini-2.5-flash (asia-southeast1)	5	41 / 45	34 / 35	2	8 / 9
2026-10-11, after fixes	**gemini-3.8-flash (global, production)**	**5**	**45 / 45**	**31 / 32**	**0**	**9 / 9**

What the eval caught

The first five-event runs exposed three bugs in the Clerk, none in the labels:

1. A correct quote running across two list items never matched.
2. The judge-employer exclusion shared its quote with the sponsor-staff clause, so a judge clause the rules do not have could still pass.
3. One model copied 29,000 characters into a single quote and ran out of output.

What it does not settle yet

Each row is one run at temperature 0, and one run is not enough to call a result settled: the production model’s three misses in the first run were unquoted claims, reset by design, that did not recur. gemini-2.5-flash’s two confident errors remain: genuine quotes, misread. No label was changed after seeing a run.

Sources: README (Evaluation); `eval/results/`, `eval/gold.json`. A confident error is a wrong value that still carried a quote we could verify. In the first gemini-2.5-flash run one event returned malformed JSON twice, so all 10 of its fields count as wrong.

Who it is for, and how we will know it works

Our problem statement, Future of Work & Enterprise Productivity, asks how people and organisations “access knowledge, collaborate, make decisions, and complete everyday work”. Choosing where to compete, and proving you are allowed to, is that kind of work.

Who it is for

- **Builders and startups** deciding where to spend their next few weeks
- **Student teams:** some events are for students only, others bar them outright
- **Accelerators and university innovation offices** screening many teams against many events
- **SME grant applicants:** the dataset covers grants and programmes, not only hackathons

Why now

- AI tools make building faster, so choosing where to compete becomes the slow part
- Rules move: the AI Builder Cup terms are a published Google Doc, “Updated automatically every 5 minutes”
- Grounded Gemini turns due diligence on one event into 10 to 60 seconds of reading and searching

How it could pay for itself (plans, not yet tested)

- Free for builders and teams: the rules engine needs no model calls, and shared cards make due-diligence cost grow with events, not users
- A paid workspace for accelerators and universities that screen whole cohorts
- A pre-launch check for organisers, so contradictions and missing dates are fixed first
- No success fees and no share of any prize or grant

How we will measure impact (no user study yet)

- **Time to a shortlist:** from a GitHub link to the events the team can actually enter
- **Ineligible entries avoided:** events marked Out or Check that a team had planned to enter
- **Calibration:** Brier score of predictions logged before entering, once results are in
- Until then we claim no time saved

Sources: theme text from aibuildercup.com/themes.html; the terms banner as saved in `eval/snapshots`; README (10 to 60 seconds; one card per event per day). The revenue items are plans.

What it cannot do yet, and what comes next

Limits, stated up front

- **Not legal advice.** Singapore's Ministry of Manpower has published no guidance on work-pass holders winning cash prizes; we say so rather than guess.
- **Devpost refuses server traffic** to its rules pages with a Cloudflare check. The nightly scout still gets dates, prizes and registrant counts; for the rules, paste them into "Add an event", or Investigate reads them through Google.
- **The eval is small:** five events, 45 fields, one run per row.
- **Grounding ties a sentence to a cited page;** it does not prove the page is right, and search results vary from run to run.
- **Employer matching** knows the big corporate families; smaller sponsors match by name only.

Next, in priority order

1. **A pilot with real teams,** measuring time to a shortlist, ineligible entries avoided and Brier scores.
2. **A larger gold set,** with several runs per model before we call any result settled.
3. **More sources for the nightly scout,** such as Hack2skill and Tencent Cloud's competition platform, with a person approving new events before they join the shared list.
4. **Sign-in with Firebase Authentication,** in place of anonymous browser sessions.

Sources: README (Limits; Evaluation). The roadmap items are plans, not commitments to dates.

Team No Fine Print

Which competitions can your team actually win? Open the live app and press “Try a sample team”: every verdict shows the clause it rests on.

Problem statement

Future of Work & Enterprise Productivity

Live app

https://no-fine-print-233540464251.asia-southeast1.run.app

Source code

https://github.com/chizheyu/no-fine-print

This deck

`docs/No_Fine_Print_deck.pdf` in the repository

Built during the event

Every line in the repository was written after the team formed; the first commit is dated 6 Oct 2026. The rule-engine design was prototyped on 5 Oct 2026, inside the official building window.

Open source under Apache-2.0

`npm test` runs 68 tests with no network and no model; `npm run eval` reruns the extraction eval against the saved snapshots.

Sources: git history (first commit, 6 Oct 2026); README (Built during the event; Run it); `npm test`, 68 passing on 11 Oct 2026.